

Chapter 6: Communication That Builds Confidence

What you say to your child becomes their inner voice.

Not immediately. But over time.

The way you speak today is the way they will think tomorrow.

The Hidden Power of Communication

Children don't just hear words. They absorb tone, emotion, and meaning.

Two parents can say the same sentence. One builds confidence. The other builds fear.

Difference = delivery.

What Damages Confidence

- Constant correction
- Harsh tone
- Comparing with others
- Ignoring their voice

Message received by child:

- "I am not good enough"
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What Builds Confidence

- Respectful tone
- Listening fully
- Encouraging effort (not just results)
- Allowing expression

Message received by child:

- "I matter"
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The 3-Part Communication Model

1. Listen First

- Do not interrupt
 - Let them finish
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2. Reflect Back

- Show you understood

Example: "You felt bad when that happened."

3. Respond Simply

- Short, clear, calm
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Replace These Common Phrases

✗ "Why are you like this?"

✓ "What happened?"

✗ "You always do this"

✓ "Let's fix this together"

✗ "Stop crying"

✓ "I'm here, tell me"

The Confidence Rule

Correct behavior without attacking identity

Wrong:

- "You are careless"

Right:

- "This was done in a hurry. Let's do it properly."
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Real-Life Scenario

Child fails a test.

✗ Reaction: "You didn't study properly."

Result:

- Shame

✓ Better: "I know this feels bad." (pause) "Let's see what went wrong and improve."

Result:

- Learning mindset
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The 80/20 Rule of Parenting Talk

- 80% connection
- 20% correction

If correction is more than connection, confidence drops.

Tone Matters More Than Words

Children remember how you made them feel. Not the exact sentence.

Same words, different tone → different impact

When to Stay Silent

Not every moment needs advice.

Sometimes:

- Just listen
- Just sit with them

Silence with presence builds trust.

If You Remember Only This

- Your words become their inner voice
 - Listen more than you speak
 - Correct behavior, not identity
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Quick Action (Apply Today)

- Replace one negative phrase with a better one
- Listen fully once without interrupting
- Appreciate effort, not just results

This is how confidence is built daily.